

Campaign Modules: Headlines to Heists

Here are three ready-to-play campaign hooks directly based on the lore and NPCs of the 2022-2026 period.

Campaign 1: The Apex Cold Wallet

- **The Premise:** Simon Bank-Firth (Sam Bankman-Fried equivalent) is awaiting trial in a secure federal holding facility. But the missing \$8 billion from his collapsed crypto exchange, Apex, wasn't lost—it was hidden.
- **The Hook:** A burned lawyer (Sarah Chen) approaches the players. She has one half of a multi-sig cryptographic key. The other half is in a safe deposit box in the Geneva Freeports.
- **The Twist:** Bank-Firth didn't just steal money from investors; he was laundering money for the "Valkyrie Group" (Russian PMC). Now, Valkyrie hitmen, FBI agents, and cartel fixers are all hunting for the keys. The players must break into the Freeports, secure the drive, and figure out how to launder or whistleblow the funds without getting assassinated.

Campaign 2: The Epworth Ledger Shard

- **The Premise:** Jeffrey Epworth is dead, but his leverage lives on. The "Epworth Ledger," containing the darkest secrets of politicians, royals, and CEOs, was broken into three encrypted shards by his blackmail insurance team.
- **The Hook:** An investigative journalist who got too close to one of the shards is found dead (ruled an "improbable suicide"). The players find their encrypted notes, pointing to a server farm in Ashburn, Virginia.
- **The Twist:** The shard is currently held by Markus Zuckman's "Omni" corporation. They aren't turning it over to the authorities; they are using it to feed their AI behavior-prediction models. The players must infiltrate the Ashburn data center, air-gapped from the internet, and extract the data while Omni's private corporate security ("The Auditors") lock down the building.

Campaign 3: The Deepfake President

- **The Premise:** It's the eve of a major global summit in 2026. President Joseph Binder is scheduled to make a speech that will drastically escalate the proxy war in Eastern Europe.
- **The Hook:** The players are contacted by Jack "Discord" Taylor, an NSA analyst currently on the run. He shows the players irrefutable proof that the President suffered a severe medical emergency three days ago and is completely incapacitated. The man scheduled to give the speech is an incredibly sophisticated AI-generated hologram and voice clone, operated by a shadow cabinet pushing for war.
- **The Twist:** The players have 48 hours to expose the deepfake. However, because of the AI explosion of 2023-2024, no one trusts digital evidence anymore. They can't just leak Jack's files; they have to physically crash the summit in Washington D.C. (heavily guarded by Secret Service and Faction 1 agents) and disrupt the broadcast on live, analog television before the war is declared.